

Q1. I have come to know that EFX is doing all the design work using open source tool gEDA. Can you explain how to make PCB layouts using this design tool?

Pooja
Through e-mail

A1. Yes, we do use gEDA Project open source tool for the complete design and production cycle.

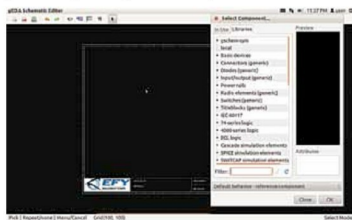


Fig. 1: gEDA Project schematic editor

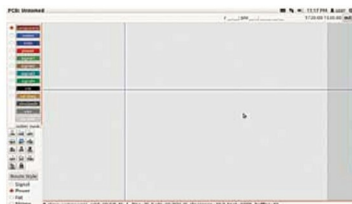


Fig. 2: gEDA Project PCB design tool

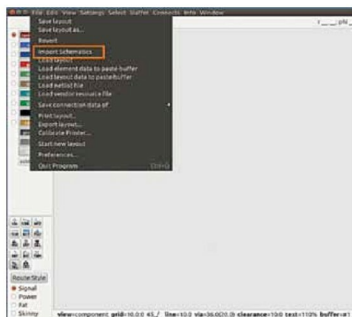


Fig. 3: Import schematic

EDA tools have become an inherent part of the product design cycle in the electronics industry. These tools help to increase the productivity due to capabilities like well-structured design flow, simulation, analysis and debugging, output data generation for manufacturing and much more. We have recently published several articles on EDA tools to introduce readers to the same.

There are hundreds of good electronic design tools

available but most of them have to be paid for or give you limited functionalities in their free version. We chose gEDA because it is one of the most matured and complete open source EDA tools and is completely configurable based on your needs. To top it all, it works on Linux platform, which gives us a more rugged environment.

The PCB design tool is very easy to learn and use. There are two ways by which you can make the PCB using this tool:

1. Make the schematic and import

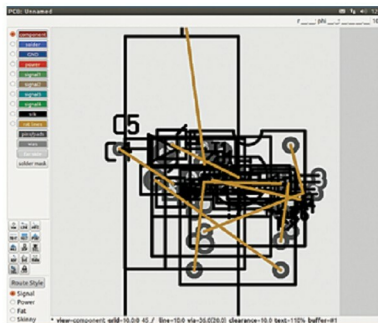


Fig. 4: All components and nets imported

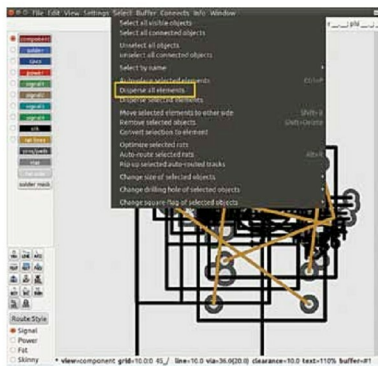


Fig. 5: All elements dispersed for comfortable placement